

CHUTNEYS · CUCUMBER

Kakdi *Chutney*

Tangy, lightly spicy, a little sweet. A cucumber chutney made with slightly raw kakdi — cooked down with tomato, tamarind and green chili, ground coarse with raw garlic, then a handful of raw diced kakdi stirred back in for those bright, crunchy, tangy bites. Wonderful with white rice, a fried protein, or an omelet.

from the kitchen of Noor

KAKDI CHUTNEY



coarse, tangy, flecked with raw kakdi



cooking down with tomato & chili



ground coarse, ready to eat

Kakdi *Chutney*

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A BOWLFUL • TANGY, LIGHTLY SPICY & A LITTLE SWEET

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- 3–4 kakdi (cucumber), slightly raw — half green, firm to the touch
- 2–3 tomatoes
- green chilies, a few
- tamarind — a small ball, or a big spoon of concentrate
- a whole head of raw garlic
- oil, for the pan
- cumin seeds (zira)
- salt (namak), to taste

Pick kakdi that's slightly hard to the touch — never soft. Don't use any that's gone soft. Amounts by feel.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Prep the kakdi.** Peel and deseed. Dice about a quarter of it very small and set aside raw — these go in at the end for tangy, crunchy bites. Cut the rest into slices or cubes.
- 2 Start the pan.** Heat oil and let the cumin seeds splutter.
- 3 Cook it down.** Add the cut kakdi, chopped tomatoes, green chilies and tamarind. Cover and cook until all the vegetables are fully soft.
- 4 Cool it.** Let the cooked mixture cool down before grinding.
- 5 Grind coarse.** In a mixer, put the raw garlic, the cooled mixture and salt. Grind just a few seconds — leave it slightly coarse, not a smooth paste.
- 6 Stir in the raw kakdi.** Tip into a bowl and mix in the reserved raw diced kakdi. Ready to eat.

Amma's note: the raw kakdi stirred in at the end is the whole trick — don't skip it, that's where the bright tangy crunch comes from. Keep the grind coarse, not smooth.

NOTES & PAIRINGS

Serve with *hot white rice and a fried protein — or with rice and an omelet.*

Pick the right kakdi — *slightly raw, half-green, firm to the touch. Never soft.*

Don't skip the raw kakdi *stirred in at the end — that's the bright, tangy crunch.*

Keep it coarse — *a few seconds in the grinder, not a smooth paste.*